Chapter – Two
Diversity in Organization

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Diversity

- Diversity is the range of human differences, including but not limited to race, ethnicity, gender, gender identity, age, social class, physical ability or attributes, religious or ethical values system, national origin, and political beliefs.
- Diversity means having a range of people with various racial, ethnic, socioeconomic, and cultural backgrounds and various lifestyles, experience, and interests. Having a variety of individuals and points of view represented in the department. Diversity is a group of people who are different in the same place.

Levels of Diversity

- The United Nations recognizes over thirty characteristics that represent diversity, but in truth, there are many more than that. Some are visible and some are not. Still, others are immutable parts of who we are, while some change many times over the course of our lives.
- There are two levels of diversity. These are
  - Surface-level diversity
  - Deep-level diversity

Levels of Diversity

Surface-level Diversity

- Surface-level diversity refers to a sort of diversity in which the features are observable and palpable. Age, color, sex, gender balance, visible disability, and physical size are just a few examples. Surface-level diversity in office activities refers to the disparities and stereotypes that can be seen merely by glancing at them or talking to them once or twice.
- Surface-level activities, whether well-intentioned or not, have the impact of making individuals feel "outcasted" and weakening their sense of community, which is a sure way to push them out of the company. These behaviors can breed skepticism in the workplace, making developing a truly diverse and inclusive atmosphere more challenging.

Levels of Diversity

Deep-level Diversity

- Non-observing qualities, or not apparent features, are included in deep-level diversity. Opinions, beliefs, and religious affiliations are among them. They're related to hidden diversity in that they're difficult to spot.
- Deep-level diversity increases engagement and productivity, according to research. When employees feel appreciated, respected, and involved, they are better, stronger, and more productive. Top management can benefit from fabulous ideas, broader views, and better solutions.

Discrimination in the Workplace

- Although diversity presents many opportunities for organizations, diversity management includes working to eliminate unfair discrimination.
- To review, unfair discrimination assumes that everyone in a group is the same rather than looking at the characteristics of individuals within the group. This discrimination is often very harmful for employees.
- The following slides provide definitions and examples of some form of discrimination in organizations.

Forms of Discrimination

Types of Discrimination	Definition	Examples from Organizations
Discriminatory Policies or Practices	Actions taken by representatives of the organization that deny equal opportunity to perform or unequal rewards for performance.	Older workers may be targeted for layoffs because they are highly paid and have lucrative benefits.
Intimidation	Over threats or bullying directed at members of specific groups of employees.	African-American employees at some companies have found nooses hanging over their work stations.
Mockery and Insults	Jokes or negative stereotypes; sometimes the result of jokes taken too far.	Arab-Americans have been asked at work whether they were carrying bombs or were members of terrorists organizations.

Forms of Discrimination

Types of Discrimination	Definition	Examples from Organizations
Exclusion	Exclusion of certain people from job opportunities, social events, discussions, or informal mentoring ; can occur unintentionally.	Many women in finance claim they are assigned to marginal job roles or are given light workloads that don't lead to promotion.
Incivility	Disrespectful treatment, including behaving in an aggressive manner, interrupting the person, or ignoring his or her opinions.	Female lawyers note that male attorneys frequently cut them off or do not adequately address their comments.

Ability

- Ability is an individual's current capacity to perform the various tasks in a job. Overall abilities are essentially made up of two sets of factors. These are-
- Intellectual Abilities
- Physical Abilities

- **Intellectual Abilities:** Intellectual abilities are abilities needed to perform mental activities such as thinking, reasoning, and problem solving. Most societies place a high value on intelligence , and for good reason. However, assessing and measuring intellectual ability are not always simple. IQ tests are designed to ascertain a person's general intellectual abilities, but the origins, influence factors, and testing of intelligence quotients are controversial.
- The seven most frequently cited dimensions making up intellectual abilities are discussed in the following slides.

Dimensions of Intellectual Ability

Dimension	Description	Job Example
Number Aptitude	Ability to do speedy and accurate arithmetic.	Accountant: Computing the sales tax on a set of items.
Verbal Comprehension	Ability to understand what is read or heard and the relationship of words to each other.	Plant manager: Following corporate policies on hiring.
Perceptual Speed	Ability to identify visual similarities and differences quickly and accurately.	Fire investigation: Identifying clues to support a charge of arson.
Inductive Reasoning	Ability to identify a logical sequence in a problem and then solve the problem.	Market researcher: Forecasting demand for a product in the next time period.

Dimensions of Intellectual Ability

Dimension	Description	Job Example
Deductive Reasoning	Ability to use logic and assess the implications of an argument.	Supervisor: Choosing between two different suggestions offered by employees.
Spatial Visualization	Ability to imagine how an object would look if its position in space were changed.	Interior decorator: Redecorating an office.
Memory	Ability to retain and recall past experiences.	Salesperson: Remembering the names of customers.

Physical Abilities

- The capacity to do tasks that demand stamina, dexterity, strength, and similar characteristics.
- Although the changing nature of work suggests intellectual abilities are increasingly important for many jobs, physical abilities have been and will remain valuable.
- Research on hundreds of jobs has identified nine basic abilities needed in the performance of physical tasks. These are described in the following slide-

Nine Basic Physical Abilities

Particulars	Explanation
Dynamic Strength	Ability to exert muscular force repeatedly or continuously over time.
Trunk Strength	Ability to exert muscular strength using the trunk muscles.
Static Strength	Ability to exert force against external objects.
Explosive Strength	Ability to expend a maximum of energy in one or a series of explosive acts.
Extent Flexibility	Ability to move the trunk and back muscles as far as possible.
Dynamic Flexibility	Ability to make rapid, repeated flexing movements.
Body Coordination	Ability to coordinate the simultaneous actions of different parts of the body.
Balance	Ability to maintain equilibrium despite forces pulling off balance.
Stamina	Ability to continue maximum effort requiring prolonged effort overtime.

END OF CHAPTER

HAVE A GOOD DAY……